



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

kanyaivākṣatayonir yā pāṇigrahaṇadūṣitā | 12.046a

punarbhūḥ prathamā soktā punaḥ saṁskāram arhati || 46 || 12.046c

kaumāraṁ patim utsṛjya yānyaṁ puruṣam āśritā | 12.047a

punaḥ patyur gr̥ham yāyāt sā dvitīyā prakīrtitā || 47 || 12.047c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 12, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Narada Smṛiti, while seemingly focused on the complexities of marriage and remarriage, offer a deeper understanding of second chances and spiritual renewal relevant even today. The text speaks of a woman who, though once betrothed ("kanyaivākṣatayonir yā pāṇigrahaṇadūṣitā"), finds that the union is not consummated or is otherwise broken. She is then considered a "punarbhūḥ prathamā," which translates to "re-established" or "re-arisen," and is eligible for remarriage ("punaḥ saṁskāram arhati"). This isn't simply about legalities; it's about the spirit's capacity to heal and begin anew after a perceived failure.

Similarly, the verses address a woman who leaves her husband after her youth ("kaumāraṁ patim utsṛjya") and seeks another ("yānyaṁ puruṣam āśritā"). Should she later return to her original husband ("punaḥ patyur gr̥ham yāyāt"), she is considered a "dvitīyā," a second instance. Again, the emphasis is not on judgment, but on the possibility of reconciliation and the cyclical nature of life and relationships.

In modern life, these verses can be interpreted metaphorically. We all experience "broken" commitments, unfulfilled promises, and paths not taken. You might find yourself feeling like you've made irreparable mistakes, or that a past decision has forever altered your course. The wisdom of the Narada Smṛiti reminds you that spiritual growth often involves embracing second chances. Just as the woman in these verses is given the opportunity to rebuild her life, you too can rise above perceived failures and create a new beginning. It encourages you to see setbacks not as permanent roadblocks, but as opportunities for transformation and deeper understanding. This isn't advocating for abandoning commitments lightly, but rather recognizing that life is rarely linear and that grace and forgiveness, both for yourself and others, are essential for spiritual progress. The journey is about learning, adapting, and continuing to strive towards your highest potential, even after stumbles.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "broken" commitments or perceived failures are you holding onto that you can reframe as opportunities for growth and renewal today?